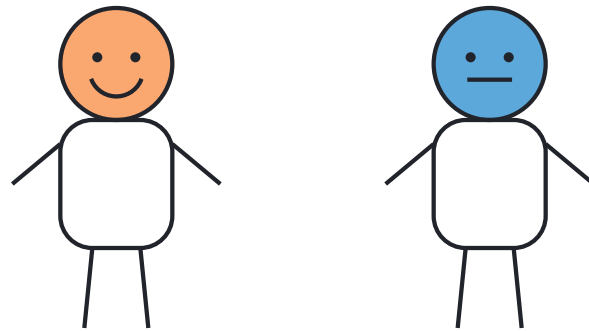




LITTLE FEELINGS SOCIAL STORIES



Coping With Separation Anxiety

A Printable Social Story With Activities

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 4-8 - Printable story + activities

A read-aloud social story with activities

Home - Classroom - Counseling

How to Share This Book

Social stories gently walk a child through a situation and model calm, kind choices. Read this book together, more than once. The repetition is what helps - it lets a child rehearse the feelings and choices before the real moment happens.

This book helps a child understand the feeling, see that it is normal, and practice calm, kind choices - before the real moment happens.

How to use it

- Read the story slowly and out loud, pointing at the pictures.
- Read it again on calm days - not only in the hard moment.
- Pause to let your child color, answer, or act out the pages.
- Praise effort and calm tries, not perfection.
- Use the calm-down tools together so they feel familiar later.

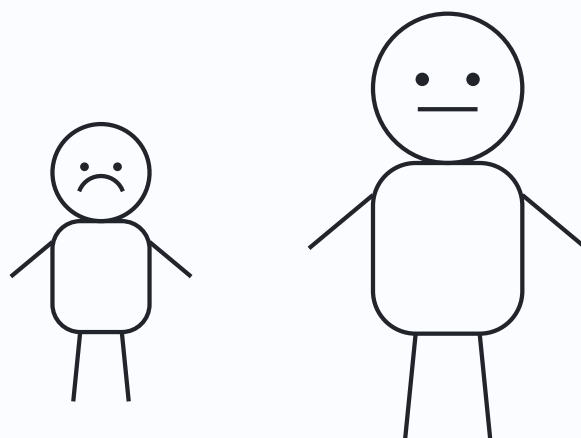
What's Inside

- 1 The Story: Saying Goodbye
- 2 My Feelings Faces
- 3 Goodbye Plan
- 4 Star Breathing
- 5 What Would You Do?
- 6 My Comfort List
- 7 My Certificate

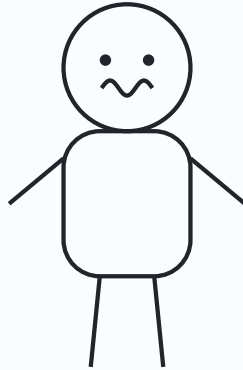


The Story

Saying Goodbye for Now

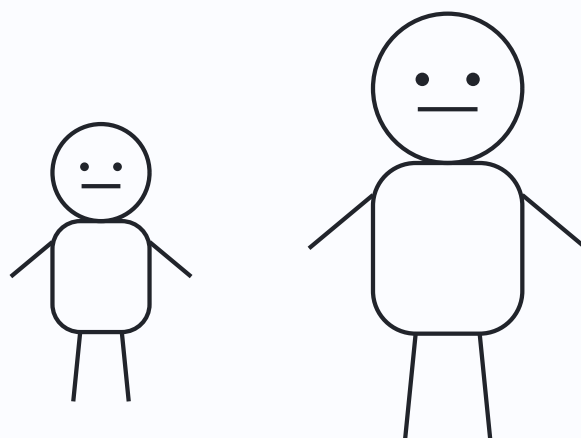


When my grown-up says goodbye, my chest feels tight.
I do not want them to go. This feeling is hard.



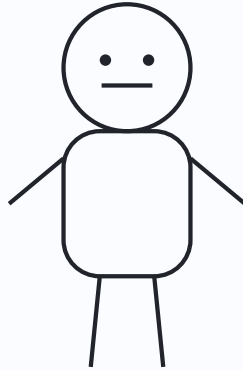
This feeling has a name: worry about being apart.

Lots of kids feel it. I am not the only one.



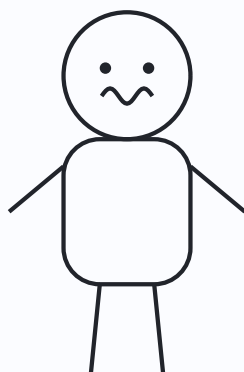
My grown-up always comes back.

Goodbye is not forever - it is just 'see you later.'



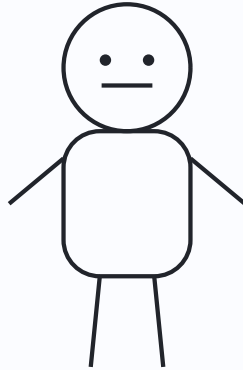
We make a goodbye plan.

A quick hug, a wave, and a special word: 'See you soon!'



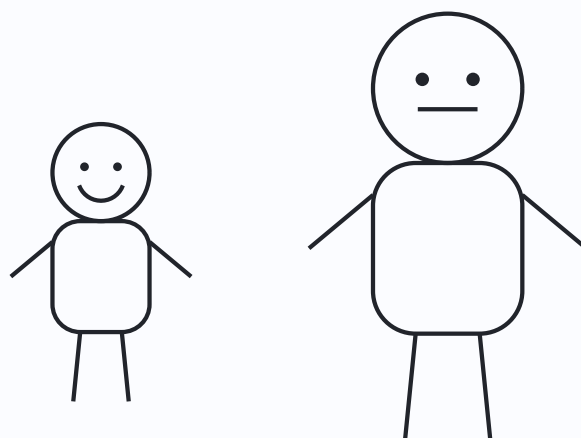
When I feel the worry, I take a slow breath.

I hold my comfort item and remember our plan.



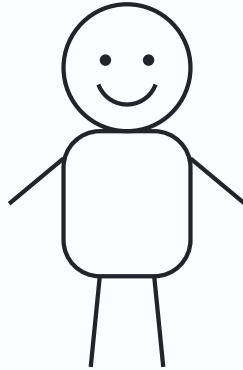
I keep my hands and mind busy.

Playing and doing things makes the time go faster.



And then - my grown-up comes back!

Just like they promised. I knew they would.



Each time, saying goodbye gets a little easier.

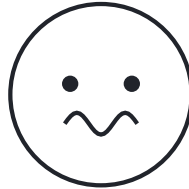
I am learning that I am safe, even when we are apart.

How Goodbye Feels

Color each face. Say the feeling out loud.



Sad



Worried



Upset



Calmer



Happy Again



Excited to Reunite

Our Goodbye Plan

- Our special goodbye is... (hug, wave, secret word)

- My comfort item is...

- My grown-up comes back at...

Star Breathing

Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it a few times until your body feels calmer.



1. Trace up a point of the star as you breathe in.
2. Trace down as you breathe out.
3. Go slowly around all five points.
4. Finish with one big, calm breath.

What Would You Do?

Read each situation together. There are many good choices! Talk it through, then write or draw what you could do.

- 1 Your grown-up drops you off and you feel like crying.**

What could you do?

- 2 You feel worried in the middle of the day.**

What could you do?

- 3 You have a new babysitter you do not know well.**

What could you do?

My Comfort List

● Things that make me feel safe are...

● People I can talk to when I feel worried are...

● Something fun I can do while I wait is...

My Calm-Down Toolkit

Out of all the tools in this book, which ones help YOU most? Draw or write your top tools here so you remember them when a big feeling comes.

1

2

3

4

5

What I Learned

- The most helpful thing I learned was...

- One thing I will try next time is...

My Feelings Journal

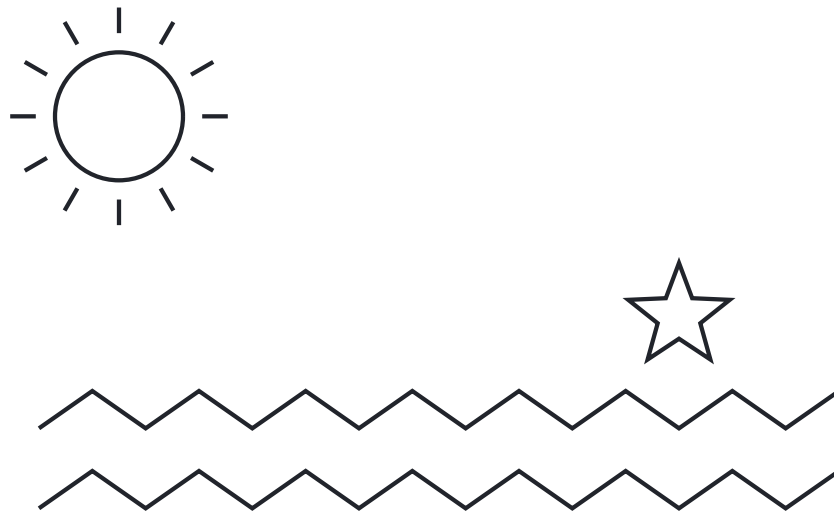
● A time I felt this feeling was...

● What helped me feel better was...

COLOR

My Calm Place

Draw and color a place where you feel calm and safe.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

WORDS

Calm Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

I can ask for help.

This will pass.

People Who Help Me

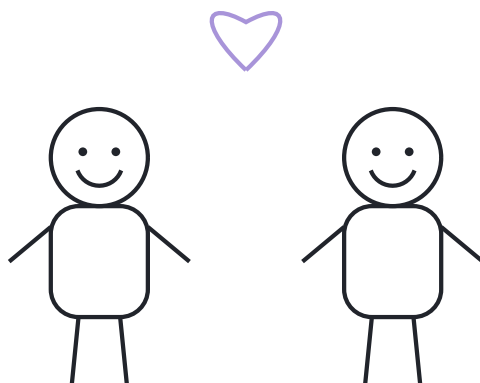
● Who are my safe grown-ups?

● How can they help me?

COLOR

Happy Together

Color two friends being kind to each other.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

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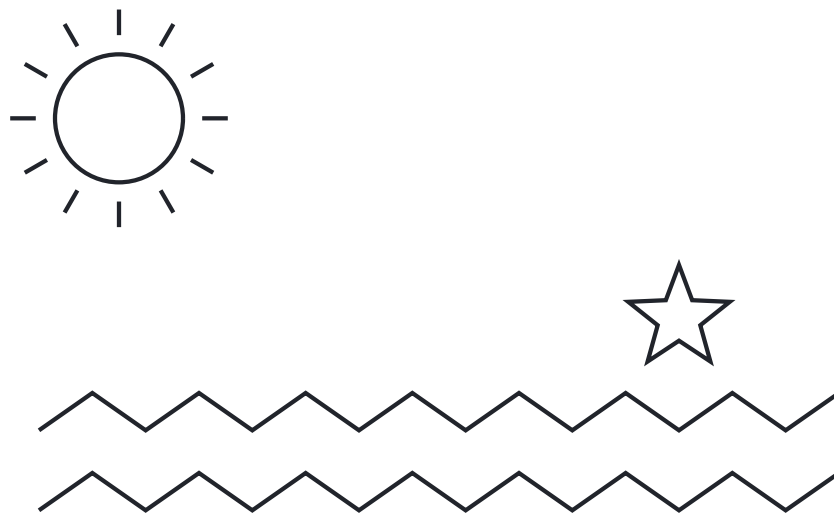
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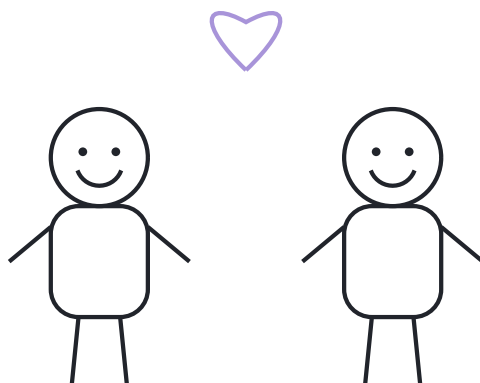
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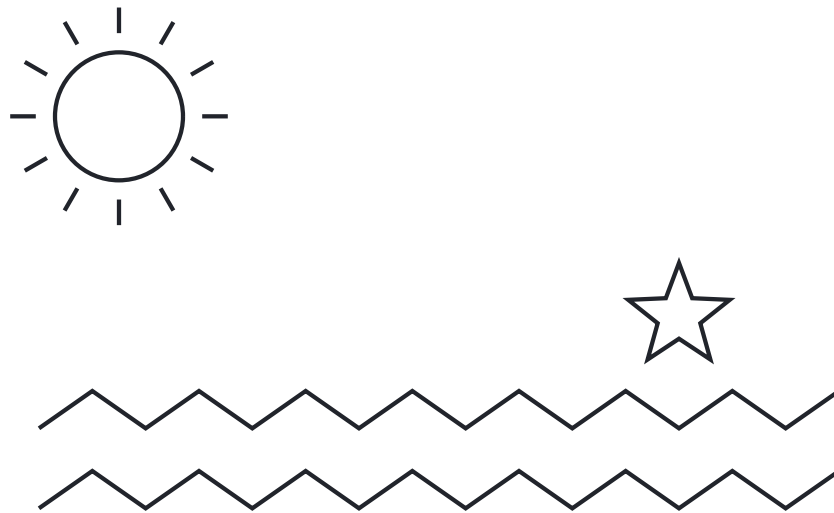
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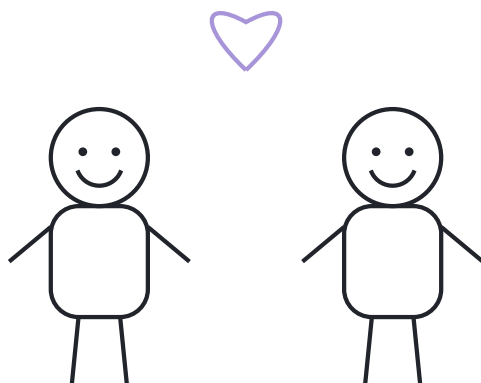
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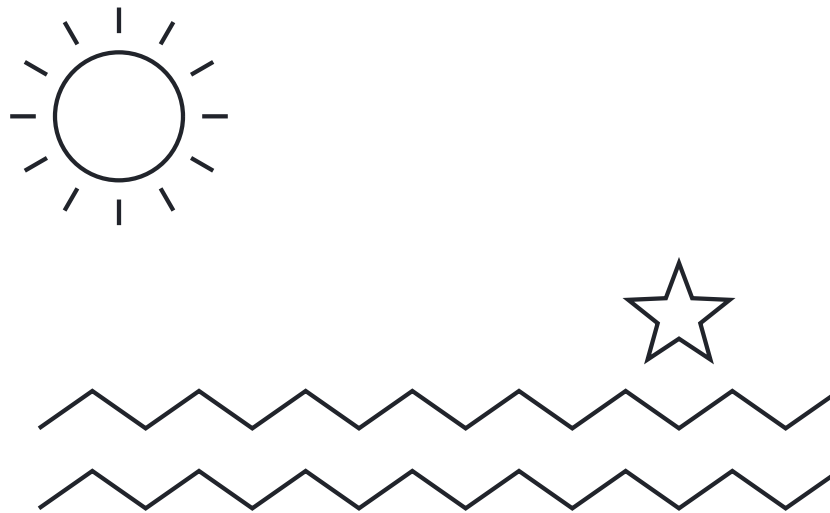
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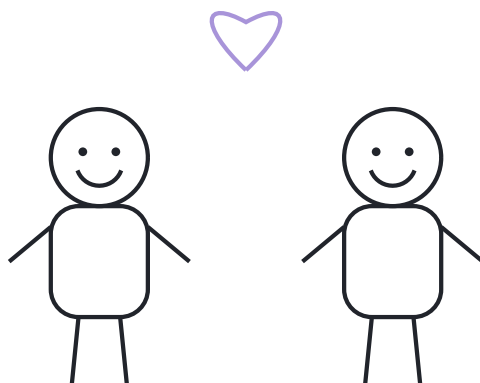
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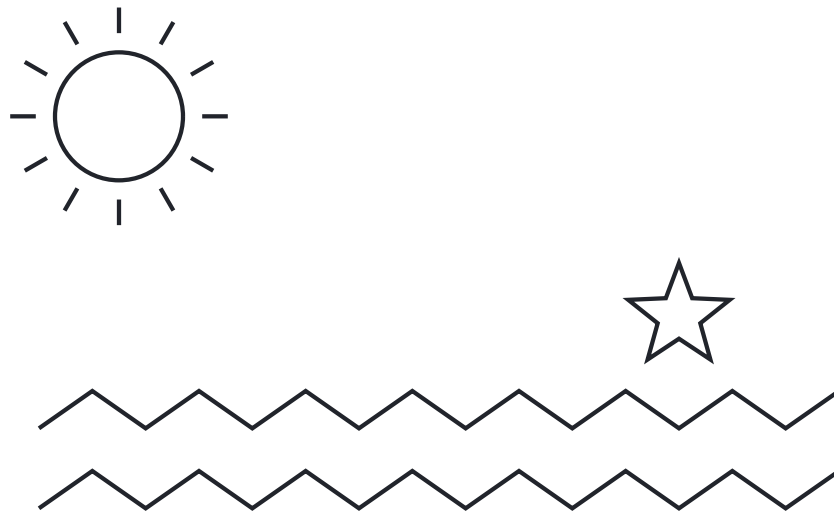
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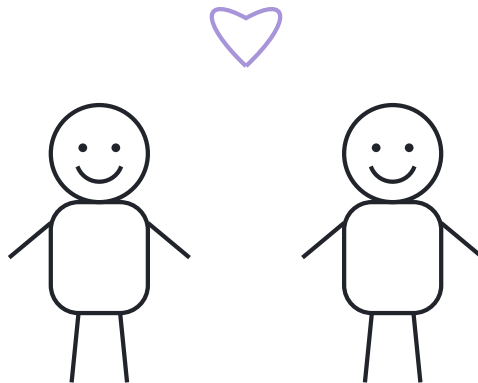
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CERTIFICATE

This certificate is proudly given to

(write your name)

for being brave when saying goodbye for now!

Grown-up

Date